A large, tilted rectangular graphic with a vibrant, abstract background of red, blue, and purple. Overlaid on this graphic is the text "TECH FEST" in a large, white, bold, sans-serif font, with "TECH" on the top line and "FEST" on the bottom line.

TECH  
FEST

# Pre-Showcase Briefing

UTS Tech Festival

This session  
is being  
recorded

### **Acknowledgment of Country**

UTS acknowledges the Gadigal people, the Boorooberongal people of the Dharug Nation, the Bidjigal people and the Gamaygal people, upon whose ancestral lands our university stands. We would also like to pay respect to the Elders both past and present, acknowledging them as the Traditional Custodians for these lands.





## Agenda

- Awards
- Pitch and Visual Aid
- Judging Criteria
- Resources
- Pod Allocation
- Agenda

# Awards

## Varied based on showcase

### Faculty Awards:

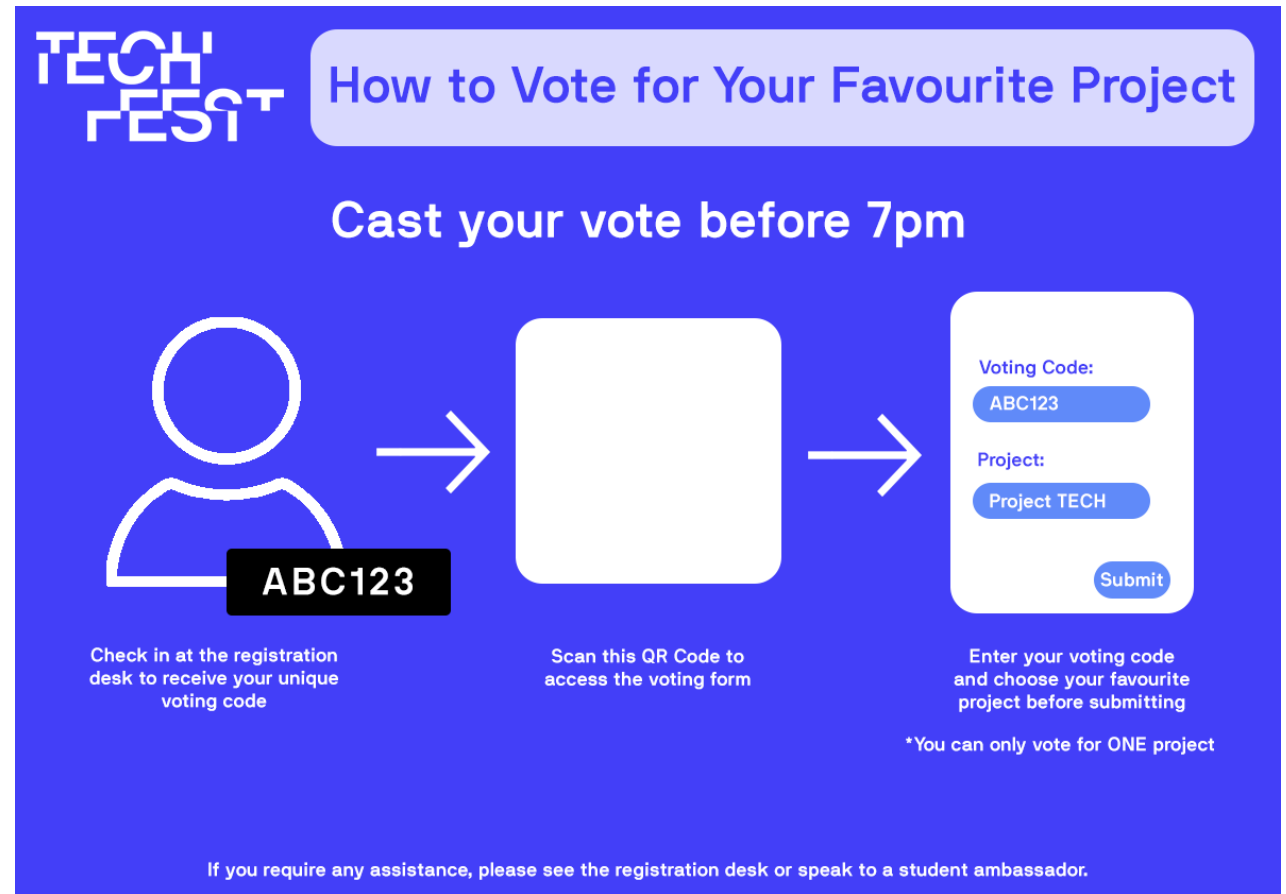
- Based on your quality of project and pitching

### Industry Award:

- May be based on your performance and/or topic relevance to the company
- Subjective based on judge's interest.

### People's Choice Award:

- Based on live voting of attendees
- Student presenters **cannot** vote
- Remind attendees to vote for you!



# Showcase Leads

- **Cybersecurity Showcase:** Xu Wang
- **Software Engineering Showcase:** Avinash Singh
- **Civil & Environmental Engineering Showcase:** Julie Jupp
- **Biomedical Engineering Showcase:** Iman Roohani & Jiao Jiao Li
- **AI Showcase:** Nabin Sharma
- **Robotics Showcase:** Marc Carmichael
- **Interaction Design Showcase:** Wade Marynowsky
- **Games Showcase:** Dale Grant

# Pitch and Visual Aid

## Pitch

Each group has approx. 5 minutes of judging:

- ~3 minutes of pitching
- ~2 minutes of questions

Things you should include in your pitch:

- Introduction/background
- Problem you are trying to solve
- Relevant research/statistics
- Live demo (if applicable)



# Pitch and Visual Aid

## Visual Aid

Please utilise your screen to:

- Demonstrate your project (applications, games, etc.), or
- Video or animation, or
- Presentation slides for pitching

Remember that the visual aid is there to support you, not the main part of your product pitch.





# Judging Criteria

## Faculty Award – Sample criteria from last year

**Note:** Actual judging criteria will be communicated to you in the coming days

### Civil & Environmental Engineering:

- Innovation and Creativity
- Technical Content
- Implementation and Application Feasibility
- Presentation and Communication

### Biomedical Engineering:

- Innovation & originality – Novelty and creativity of the project.
- Technical execution – Design quality and technical soundness.
- Impact & relevance – Biomedical significance of the project.
- Communication – Clarity and effectiveness of presentation.



# Judging Criteria

## Industry's Best Choice

- Criteria is different for each sponsor.
- Judges will be provided with a summary of your project in advance
- Make sure to check your summary when we release it.



**DriveGuard**

The goal for the team is to develop a machine learning model that utilises object detection for the purposes of detecting antisocial driving behaviours. These behaviours range from illegal u-turns, tailgating and erratic driving instances. Prior to collecting the data and building the models the team needed to fully grasp the key elements of the problem by clearly defining variables, constraints, and assumptions.



**DocumentSage**

Document Sage is a document-aware AI assistant integrated with Discord. Built using Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) and LLM techniques, it allows users to query internal documents in real time by uploading PDFs or text. Designed for small businesses, it offers zero-cost deployment, privacy controls, profanity filtering, and multi-query handling. The system was developed as part of UTS's AI/Analytics Capstone and includes a working demo with full functionality.



**WellnessChat**

The project focuses on the development of an AI-driven chatbot capable of engaging in emotionally supportive and contextually relevant conversations related to mental health. The chatbot is built on a pre-trained large language model, which is fine-tuned using the Unsloth framework on a mental health dialogue dataset. The objective is to enhance the model's ability to respond with empathy, maintain coherence, and exhibit emotional sensitivity.



**GestureFly3.0**

This project enables intuitive drone control using real-time hand gestures captured via a laptop webcam. The user controls a drone using easy and intuitive hand gestures, the drone is able to comprehensively



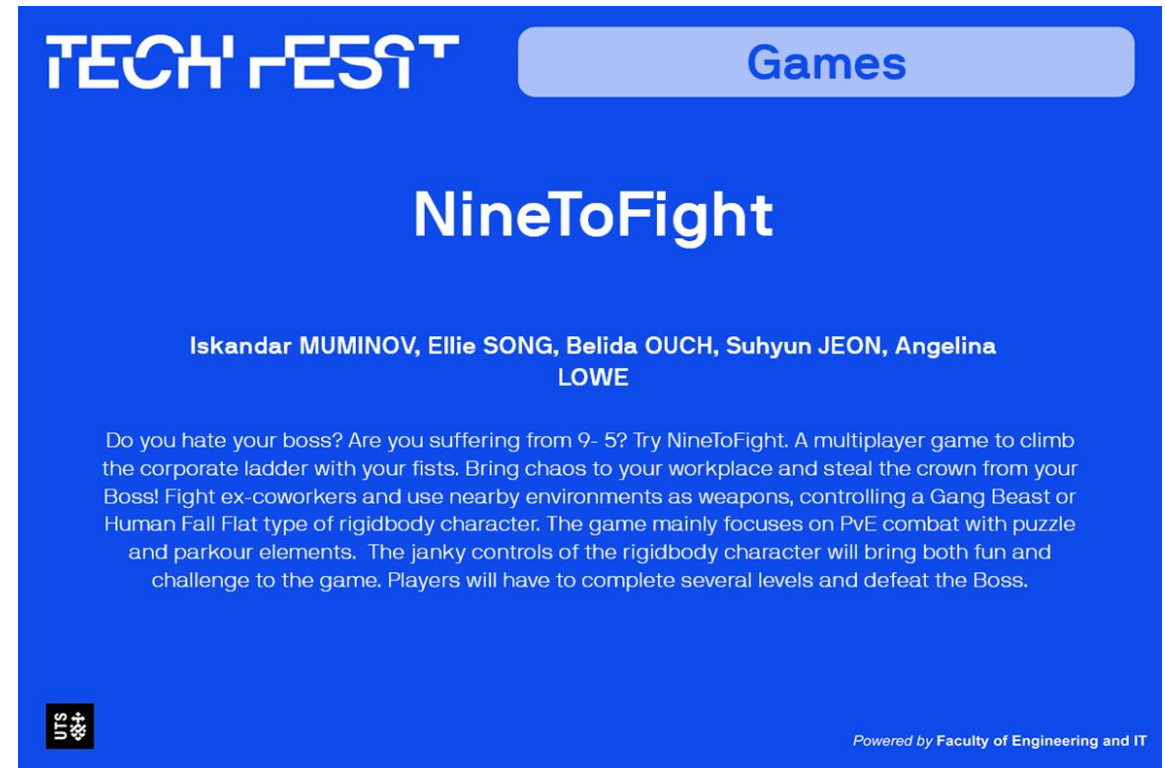
# Resources

## Signages

To increase the visibility of your project, you will be provided with a project sign on a plastic stand with:

- Project Name
- Team Members
- Project Description

The plastic stand will be collected at the end of the showcase, but you are free to keep the paper sign.



# Resources

## Pods

1 table + 1 screen with inbuilt speakers

Access to power (for personal computers, prototyping equipment etc). One HDMI or VGA cable for connecting your computer.

If you need interaction equipment (such as Kinect or LeapMotion), make sure you borrow it in advance.

Software cannot be loaded onto the pod computers, so it is best to bring your own laptops for visual aid on screen.

Sound must be relatively quiet since it is a shared space, or you can provide headphones.



**Important:** Ensure your device has a HDMI port. If not, you will need to bring your own HDMI adapter or convertor. No adaptors or special cables will be provided on the day.

# Pod Allocations

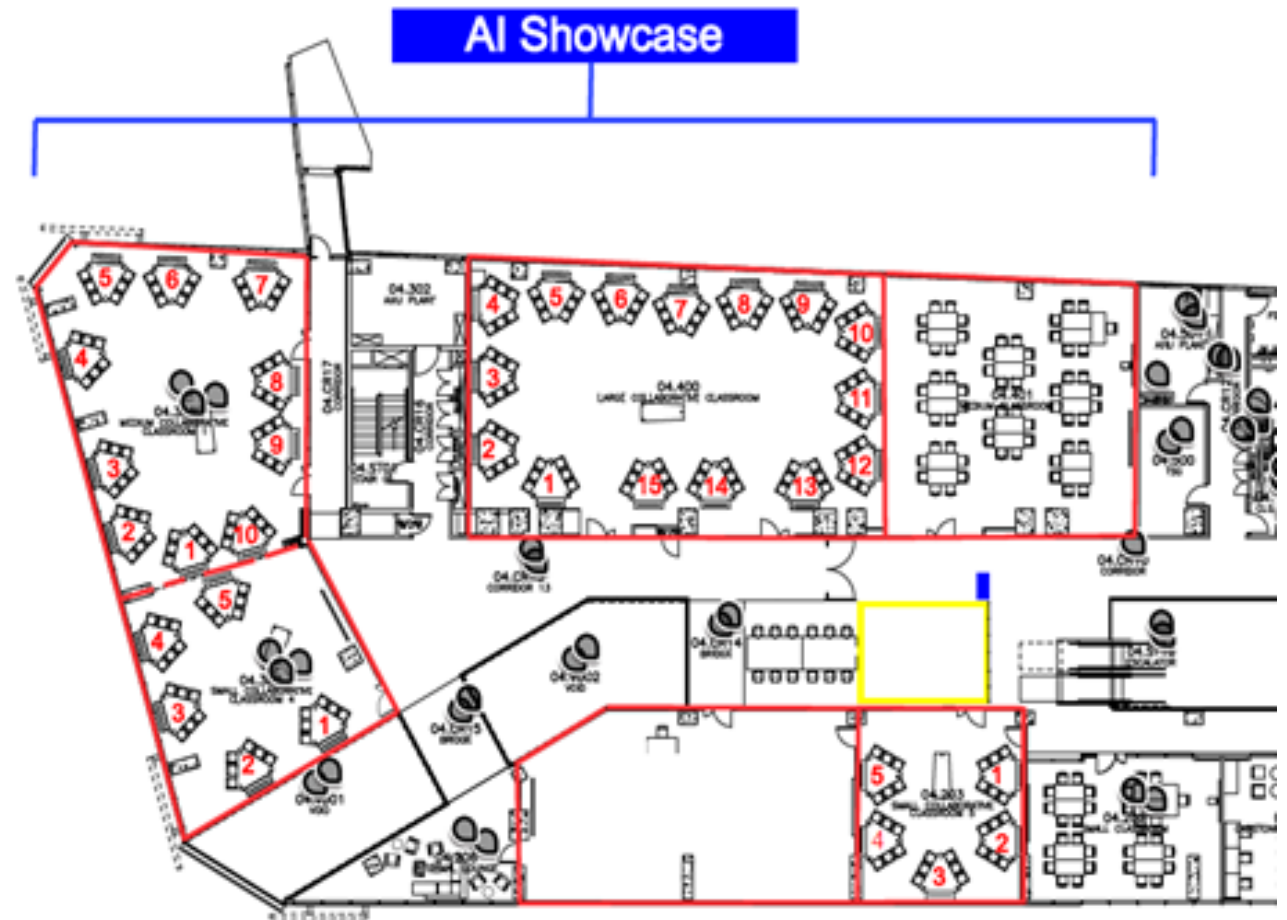
Your pod allocation will be provided in the next announcement.

Pod allocations cannot be changed because of preference. Exceptions include:

- Accessibility issues
- Equipment / space issues

*(Contact your showcase lead ASAP. Changes on the day will not be accepted)*

Our team will be present during your set up time. If you have any issue with your pod on the day, please talk to our staff ASAP – wearing UTS lanyards.





# Agenda

**Subject to change based on showcase**

- 1.00pm ~ 3.00pm: Presenters arrive and set up.
- 3.30pm: Tech Fest Team arrives to set up.
- 4.00pm: Opening ceremonies start.
- 4.15pm: Judging begins.
- 5.30pm: Catering arrives.
- 7.00pm: Judging and Voting closes.
- 7.15pm: Closing Ceremony and Announcement.
- 7.30pm: Showcase end and pack up.



# SHOWCASE YOUR PROJECT

## TECH FEST HIGH SCHOOL EXPERIENCE 2026

We're inviting students to showcase their tech fest projects to high school students (years 9–11).

### On the day you can:

- Demonstrate your project
- Talk about your experience at UTS
- Inspire future engineering & IT students

### Interested? Send us:

- Team member names + email addresses
- Project title
- Short project blurb
- Discipline category
- Any booth requirements

**You'll receive a \$50 gift card as a thank you for participating**

### DETAILS

Monday, 22 June 2026

10:00am–1:00pm

(set-up from 9:00am)

CB11.04.300 / cb11.04.301